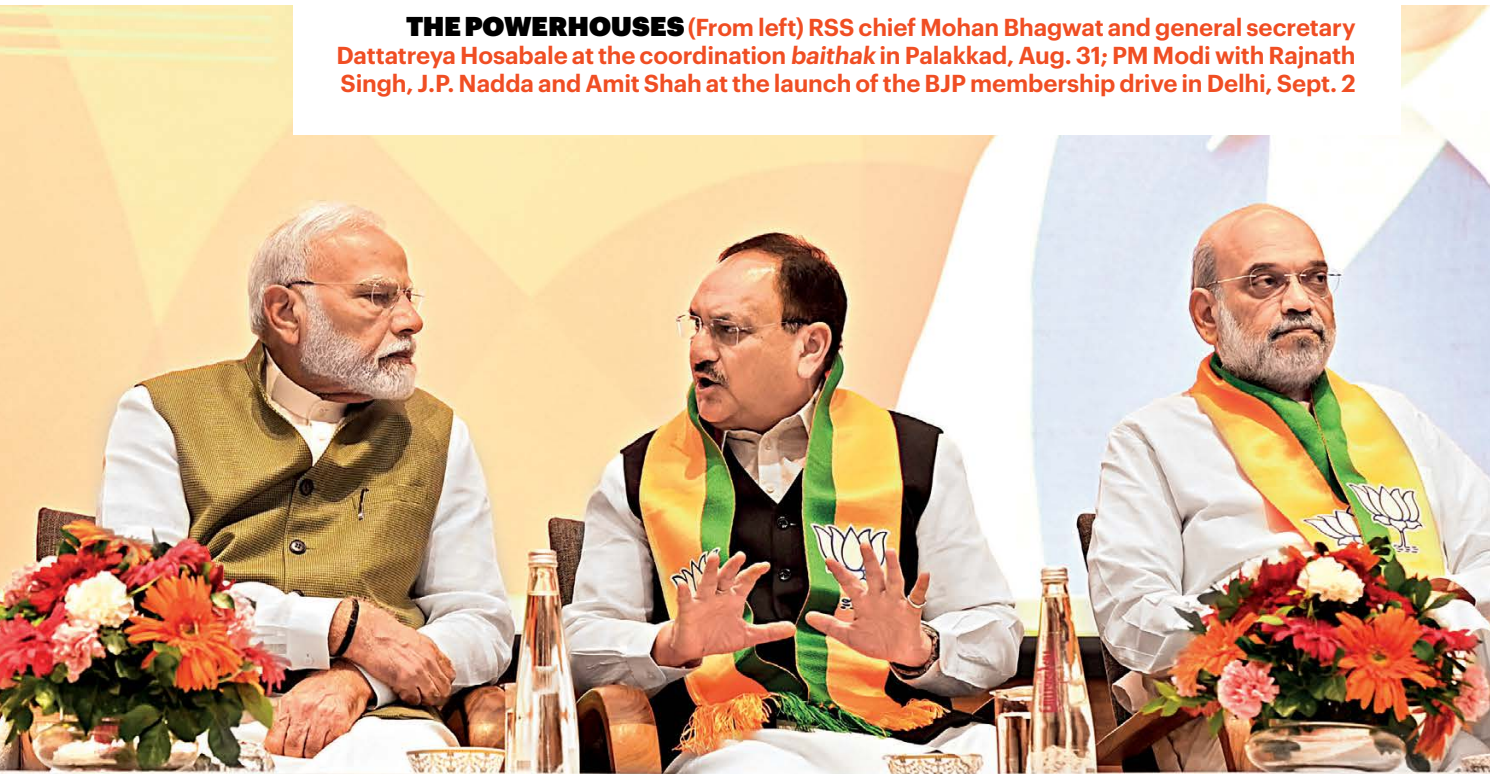


THE POWERHOUSES (From left) RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat and general secretary Dattatreya Hosabale at the coordination *baithak* in Palakkad, Aug. 31; PM Modi with Rajnath Singh, J.P. Nadda and Amit Shah at the launch of the BJP membership drive in Delhi, Sept. 2

CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

E FAMILY FEUD

MENDING FENCES

- **BJP leaders Amit Shah, Rajnath Singh and J.P. Nadda now regularly meet RSS leaders Dattatreya Hosabale and Suresh Soni to discuss issues. RSS's choices for governors accommodated**
- **In poll-bound states, Ram Madhav returns to the BJP for J&K. Sahsarkaryavahs Arun Kumar (Haryana), Atul Limaye (Maharashtra), and Alok Kumar (Jharkhand) too working with the party**
- **BJP appoints poll managers in all four poll-bound states in consultation with RSS. Sends instructions to ensure engagement with local RSS leaders**
- **Modi govt revokes 44-year-old ban on govt officials joining/ attending RSS programmes as a conciliatory gesture**
- **RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat now gets elite ASL security cover. Only 7 others qualify for it, PM Modi among them**

mir—going to the polls soon. The churn within the country's extensive saffron *parivar* is palpable even as its spearhead, the BJP, struggles to regain its pre-eminence.

THE BJP IMPERATIVE

Modi 3.0 is an epoch-defining time for the BJP and the Sangh in more ways than one. The RSS will celebrate its centenary year in 2025, while the BJP is now in an unprecedented third term in power at the Centre. But the reduced tally in the general election has prompted the party to become "future-ready". On July 28, Prime Minister Narendra Modi had convened a conclave with the party's 13 chief ministers, their deputy CMs and other top brass of the party. The closed-door sessions discussed threadbare a painful subject—the party's under-performance in the Hindi heartland states. Earlier, the BJP had also convened state executive meetings to solicit feedback. Sources say even the party's ability to convert PM Modi's personal cachet with the electorate into votes came into question.

The party leadership's dual challenge is to cement the centre while also cleaning up the peripheries. First it has to find a successor to party president Nadda, who is currently on an extension after his tenure ended on June 30. His is only one of many top positions that will have to be furnished with new faces. The BJP has an unwritten one-person, one-post rule—and Nadda falls afoul of that as do C.R. Patil (Gujarat unit chief), G. Kishan Reddy (Telangana) and Bandi Sanjay Kumar (national general secretary). But before demitting office, Nadda has to make the transition smooth for his successor. Not only must he steer the reparation of ties with